

Craigslist cleanup

After being accused of promoting trafficking, Craigslist reportedly has decided to pull the plugs on its adult services section

Samsung Galaxy tab

Samsung claims its Galaxy tab is better than the iPad. It supports Flash, will run Froyo and will be upgradeable to Gingerbread

Feature

a single analog stick, a D-pad, two trigger buttons, two game buttons (X and circle) and the PS button. This controller will become quite absolutely crucial while playing first person shooter games, with the navigation controller in the left hand mimicking the function of a keyboard and the motion controller in the other hand doing the work of a mouse.

Add-ons for an add-on

Sony is releasing PlayStation Move along with two accessories for the controllers. A charging station which can charge two Move controllers (or one pair of Move and Navigation controller) will be available in India for Rs. 1,999. In lieu of

the charging stations, the controllers can be charged by connecting them to PlayStation 3's USB ports. However, this limits the number of controllers that can be simultaneously charged to just two.

The other accessory that Sony is releasing is the "Shooting Attachment" for the PlayStation Move controller. The controller fits snugly into the attachment which appears to be the size of a hand-gun making it easy to operate with one hand. This attachment will be available at launch for Rupees 999.

Hands-on

We got our hands on the PlayStation Move Starter Pack for about two hours. This pack contains includes Move motion controller, PlayStation Eye camera and a demo disc. The disc contains a video tutorial for setting up the system, firmware update and nine game demos. The demo system was already updated and setup for us, so we really cannot comment on the process. We were told that the game demos on the disc need to be installed on the console's hard drive. The PlayStation Eye camera was placed under the television and it was switched to wide-angle mode. The motion controller can be used to navigate through the XMB by moving it around while holding down the trigger.

The motion controller needs to be calibrated each time you start the game. Games that can be played sitting down have a simple

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a peculiar calibration process in which the user needs to sit on the floor and hold the controller in a position outlined on the screen. It was hard to figure out what exactly the system wanted us to do and neither we nor the Sony reps were able to get it to work. This was a worrisome sign which reminded us of the frustration with getting the Eye Toy or the PlayStation Eye camera to cooperate during calibration process. We faced similar issue with another game called Beat Sketcher which actually had a very simple, point and push calibration process. In this case, the system failed to respond to button presses on the controller, even after several attempts.

Apart from these couple of setbacks, the two hours we spent was generally a pleasant experience. The technology and its applications did not overwhelm us; however, at the very least it reassured us. We were quite relieved to know that Sony has finally nailed motion-sensing technology with PlayStation Move, after its less than successful attempts in the past. The underlying technology may be more advanced than what Wii uses. However, for all practical purposes, the overall experience with PlayStation Move was like Wii in the early days all over again. The applications of the technology that we saw at the demo were pretty straightforward and mostly predictable. We may have to wait a while longer till the developers get the hang of the technology and start applying it in innovative ways, just like

calibration process which requires the user to point the controller towards the camera and press a button. A more complex calibration process used by some games requires the user to stand in front of the camera, such that his or hers captured image fits into a white box on the screen. Then you need to press a button on the controller once while holding it over the head and then again while holding it to the side. This way the camera records how high and wide the user's body profile is.

One game in particular, Eye Pet Move Edition, had

we have seen with Nintendo Wii. As it stands, the only advantage Sony has over Nintendo is that PlayStation 3 console is capable of HD graphics, as opposed to SD graphics on Wii.

Games on the move

The PlayStation Move will launch alongside four games that are specifically designed for the technology. Some games will be exclusively available through PSN, whereas there are a few games already in the market that can work with Move controller after downloading a patch. Here is a quick word about the games that were part for the PlayStation Move demo.

The Shoot

This is an on-the-rail shooter where the player is part of various movie shoots. The core game-play is pretty straightforward about shooting the bad guys and not hitting civilians. This game had the best visuals of the lot and was the easiest to kill time with.

Sports Champion

Sports Champion can best be described as Sony's version of Wii Sports. The disc contains games like Table Tennis, Beach Volleyball, Archery, Gladiator Duels, Bocce and Disc Golf. Out of this lot, Table Tennis and Disc Golf were on demo and Table Tennis in particular was impressive in terms of control. The system was able to capture subtle movement like twisting of the arm which lets the player add spin to the strokes. The game also tracks player's position and accordingly the character on the screen switches between forehand and backhand. On the flipside, this game may require a pretty wide room to play—with minimum chances of collision—particularly when there are two people playing simultaneously.

Echochrome ii [PSN Only]

The developers of Japan Studio have done it again with another brilliant game design which uses light and shadows for some mind-bending puzzles. A solid structure is placed against a white background and a flashlight in front of the structure casts shadow on the background. Player controls the position of the flashlight to change the shape of the shadow and solve the puzzle. Of all the games we tried at the demo, this one was by far the most interesting application of the motion controller. ■